## ▼ DEBATE | STATE FINANCES: THE TIGHTROPE WALK



**"The issue is the Centre's step-motherly treatment.... It is controlling GST and borrowing and discriminating against states like Kerala"**

**K.N. BALAGOPAL**
Finance Minister, Kerala

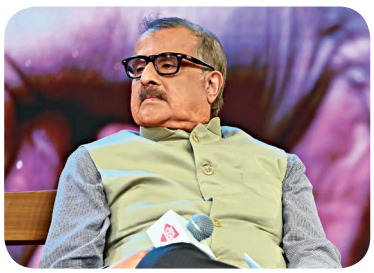


**"There's a need to take a more nuanced view when discussing state finances"**

**PINAKI CHAKRABORTY**
Economist

**"There should be a relook at the 3 per cent fiscal deficit limit fixed to determine whether a state is economically viable or not"**

**K.M. CHANDRASEKHAR**
Former Union Cabinet Secretary



## INDUSTRIALISING KERALA: OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES



**"The first phase of the Vizhinjam Port...should be ready by May 2024. The first ship, with the equipment, is coming by September-end"**

**RAJESH JHA**
MD & CEO, Vizhinjam Port

**"We are victims of perception. There is a perception that nothing happens in Kerala. Kerala has to launch a PR exercise for this"**

**S.N. RAGHUCHANDRAN NAIR**
President, Trivandrum Chamber of Commerce & Industry

## ▼ TOURISM | DESTINATION EXTRAORDINARY: EMERGING OPPORTUNITIES IN GOD'S OWN COUNTRY



BANDEEP SINGH

**"Kerala is a multiple USP destination. Backwaters have been our most important destination in the last decade, and now we have added Ayurveda and its various treatment options, and caravan tourism"**

**P.A. MOHAMMED RIYAS**
PWD & Tourism Minister, Kerala